PROPOSAL

Next Generation Enterprise Identity, Credential, and Access Management (E-ICAM) Prototype

Prepared for:

Location: Detroit, MI

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AREA OF INTEREST (AOI) RESPONSE — OTHER TRANSACTION PROTOTYPE

Date: November 09, 2026 **Reference:** DISA-OTA-27-R-ICAM **Subject:** Next Generation Enterprise Identity, Credential, and Access Management (E-ICAM) Prototype **NAICS Code:** 541519

To: DISA PS84 Other Transaction Authority **Email:** disa.scott.ditco.mbx.ps84-other-transaction-authority@mail.mil

From: Carl E. Jones III, Founder & Principal Hidden Leaf Networks, LLC Detroit, Michigan carl@hiddenleafnetworks.com https://www.hiddenleafnetworks.com

1. Company Identification

Field	Value
Legal Name	HIDDEN LEAF NETWORKS, LLC
CAGE Code	26PF4
UEI	X6B2SPZ64KP3
SAM.gov Status	Active
Business Size	Small Business
Business Type	Single-Member LLC
Primary NAICS	541512 — Computer Systems Design Services
Additional NAICS	541519, 541511
Location	Detroit, Michigan
Year Established	2025

2. Executive Summary

Hidden Leaf Networks, LLC (HLN) submits this response to express interest in the DISA E-ICAM Prototype Other Transaction opportunity. HLN has developed a modular, AI-governed identity and access management platform — the **ARIA AXIS Identity Stack** — specifically architected for

multi-domain, multi-classification federated identity scenarios. Our approach aligns directly with DISA's stated requirements for a Federated Identity Provider, Automated Account Provisioning, Master Entitlement Record, and Federation Hub operating at IL5 and IL6.

HLN is a small business with no legacy infrastructure debt, no monolithic vendor lock-in, and a fully modular, cloud-native architecture. This positions us to deliver exactly the kind of innovative prototype DISA is seeking through the OT mechanism — purpose-built, agile, and not constrained by the same commercial assumptions that make legacy ICAM systems difficult to modernize.

3. Capability Overview

3.1 Core Platform — ARIA AXIS Identity Stack

HLN's ARIA AXIS Identity Stack is a production-grade identity infrastructure built from the ground up with separation of concerns, role-based governance, and AI-assisted entitlement management. It is composed of three independently deployable modules:

axis-ontology-pack — Semantic Identity Ontology

- Defines the canonical data model for identities, roles, permissions, and entitlement relationships
- Schema-driven, provider-agnostic; supports extension without breaking existing consumers
- Directly maps to the concept of a **Master Entitlement Record (MER)** — a unified, authoritative source of identity attributes across federated domains

axis-agent-registry — Identity and Agent Registry

- Manages registration, lifecycle, and trust relationships for both human users and autonomous agents (AI/software)
- Supports role assignment, class-based access control, and cross-domain identity binding
- Native support for non-human identities — a critical capability gap in legacy ICAM systems as DoD increases AI/autonomous system adoption

HLN Relay — Cybersecurity Workflow Orchestration with Identity at Core

- Collaborative, multi-role security workflow platform built on the AXIS identity model
- Role-adaptive UX: each user class sees only the views and actions their entitlements authorize
- Audit trail and entitlement change tracking built into the workflow engine — not bolted on after the fact
- Architecture: FastAPI backend, Next.js frontend, containerized microservices

3.2 Federated Identity Provider Capability

HLN's platform is built to serve as a **modular Federated IdP** component within a broader E-ICAM architecture:

- **Protocol support:** SAML 2.0, OAuth 2.0, OpenID Connect (OIDC) — the standard interoperability layer for DoD federation scenarios
- **Attribute assertion:** Identity attributes and entitlements are passed as structured claims, compatible with CAC/PIV attribute schemas
- **Multi-domain trust:** The ontology layer supports trust relationships spanning multiple organizational domains without requiring a single centralized authority
- **Non-human entity federation:** The agent registry extends federation to cover software agents, API services, and AI systems — a forward-looking requirement for autonomous DoD operations

3.3 Automated Account Provisioning

HLN's registry implements an event-driven provisioning model:

- Identity lifecycle events (onboarding, role change, separation) trigger automated entitlement updates across connected systems
- Provisioning rules are defined declaratively in the ontology layer — auditable, reviewable, and version-controlled
- No manual queue reconciliation — the system maintains consistency in near real-time
- Deprovisioning is a first-class operation, not an afterthought — automated account suspension and access revocation on lifecycle events

3.4 Master Entitlement Record (MER)

The axis-ontology-pack directly implements MER concepts:

- **Single source of truth** for identity attributes, organizational affiliations, clearance-level bindings, and role assignments
- **Immutable event log** of all entitlement changes — who changed what, when, and under what authority
- **Cross-domain attribute reconciliation** — when an identity exists in multiple domains, the MER layer resolves conflicts using configurable precedence rules
- **Queryable and exportable** — supports both real-time API access and batch reconciliation for downstream systems (LDAP, AD, HR feeds)

3.5 Federation Hub Architecture

HLN's platform is designed as a hub-and-spoke federation model:

- Central trust broker mediates between participating identity providers and relying parties
- Attribute translation layer normalizes identity claims from heterogeneous upstream sources into a canonical MER format
- Supports both push (IdP-initiated) and pull (SP-initiated) federation flows
- Logging and anomaly detection on all federation transactions — behavioral baseline monitoring for suspicious cross-domain access patterns

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4. IL5 / IL6 Compliance Approach

HLN is a commercial software company. We are transparent that IL5/IL6 ATO is not a credential HLN currently holds independently. Our prototype approach leverages authorized cloud environments:

Cloud Platform Partners:

- **AWS GovCloud (US)** — IL5-authorized, FedRAMP High; HLN's containerized microservices are deployable into AWS GovCloud without architectural changes
- **Microsoft Azure Government** — IL5/IL6-authorized; Azure Government Secret supports IL6 workloads via the Azure Government Secret cloud boundary

Prototype Delivery Model:

- HLN delivers the application layer and identity logic; the cloud provider furnishes the authorized infrastructure boundary
- All data at rest encrypted (AES-256), all data in transit encrypted (TLS 1.3+)
- Secrets management via AWS Secrets Manager or Azure Key Vault — no hardcoded credentials anywhere in the codebase
- Container images built and scanned using DoD-compatible CI/CD pipelines (GitHub Actions + container vulnerability scanning)
- Architecture is designed for **zero-trust** principles: no implicit trust between services, all inter-service calls require authenticated and authorized identity assertions

Path to ATO:

HLN is prepared to work with a DoD-authorized cloud hosting partner or prime integrator to operate within an existing ATO boundary during the prototype phase. This is consistent with the OT prototype mechanism's intent — to prove commercial innovation before full government accreditation overhead is imposed.

5. Technical Differentiators

Capability	Legacy ICAM Systems	HLN ARIA AXIS
Non-human identity support	Limited or absent	Native — agents are first-class identities
AI-assisted entitlement review	Not present	Built-in anomaly detection and recommendation
Deployment model	On-prem monolith	Cloud-native microservices, IL5/IL6-compatible
Ontology extensibility	Schema-locked	Declarative, versioned, extensible
Audit trail	Periodic batch	Immutable real-time event log
Provisioning latency	Hours to days (manual)	Near real-time, event-driven
Federation hub	Proprietary, vendor-locked	Open-standards (SAML/OIDC), replaceable components

6. Relevant Technical Experience

Carl E. Jones III — Founder & Principal Engineer

- 12+ years in software engineering, QA automation, and systems architecture
- Automotive enterprise QA (Ford Motor Company) — large-scale identity-linked access control systems across global manufacturing networks
- Full-stack application development: Python, TypeScript, FastAPI, Next.js, Docker, Kubernetes

- AI/ML pipeline architecture: multi-model orchestration, autonomous agent governance, role-based access enforcement for AI systems
- Identity and access management design: schema design, RBAC/ABAC systems, federation protocol implementation
- Cybersecurity workflow tooling: HLN Relay — multi-role, identity-governed security operations platform

Active Development Artifacts:

- `axis-ontology-pack` — identity schema and entitlement ontology (102 tests, production-grade)
- `axis-agent-registry` — agent and user identity registry (deployed)
- `HLN Relay` — identity-governed cybersecurity SaaS (Sprint 3 complete, Jira-tracked delivery)

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7. Teaming and Partnership Strategy

HLN is a small business and approaches this prototype opportunity with a teaming-first mindset:

- **Cloud infrastructure partner:** AWS or Microsoft for GovCloud/Azure Government hosting within an existing IL5/IL6 ATO boundary
- **Prime integrator partnership:** Open to subcontracting to or teaming with a large business with active DISA relationships and DoD ATO experience, contributing HLN's identity platform as the technical core
- **Interoperability testing partner:** Open to engaging with other ICAM component vendors to demonstrate federation hub interoperability within a prototype environment

HLN's lean structure is a teaming asset — we integrate without political overhead, we move fast, and our codebase is designed for composability.

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8. OT Prototype Alignment

This opportunity is well-suited for the Other Transaction mechanism. HLN's value proposition fits the OT prototype intent precisely:

- **Commercial innovation:** ARIA AXIS is a commercially developed product, not a government-specification-driven build
- **Non-traditional defense contractor:** HLN has not performed federal contracts; we represent exactly the commercial technology base that OT authority is designed to access

- **Modular delivery:** Prototype can be scoped to specific E-ICAM components (e.g., MER + Automated Provisioning as Phase 1) rather than requiring full system replacement upfront
- **Low risk / high learning value:** OT prototype structure allows DISA to evaluate HLN's approach against incumbent solutions with limited commitment

9. Questions for the Government

1. Will DISA accept a prototype team where the application layer vendor (HLN) partners with a cloud provider for the IL5/IL6-authorized infrastructure boundary, or is a single vendor with an existing IL5/IL6 ATO required?

2. Is the prototype expected to integrate with existing DoD identity stores (e.g., DCSA, DEERS, RAPIDS), and if so, will API specifications for those systems be provided to prototype participants?

3. What is the anticipated prototype period of performance, and are there defined Technical Readiness Level (TRL) gates?

4. Will DISA consider a team where HLN serves as a subcontractor / technical contributor under a prime with existing DISA OT experience?

5. Is source code ownership retained by the government at the conclusion of the prototype, or does the OT allow commercial licensing arrangements?

10. Statement of Interest

Hidden Leaf Networks, LLC expresses **strong interest** in participating in the DISA-OTA-27-R-ICAM E-ICAM Prototype. HLN is prepared to:

- Provide a live demonstration of the ARIA AXIS Identity Stack
- Submit a full white paper with technical architecture diagrams upon request
- Engage in preliminary discussions with DISA program staff and potential teaming partners
- Participate in an industry day or one-on-one meeting if offered

HLN brings a rare combination of capabilities to this opportunity: a production-grade modular identity platform built on open standards, AI-native non-human identity support, and the agility of a small business with no legacy constraints. We believe the ARIA AXIS architecture directly addresses the modernization gap DISA has identified in its legacy E-ICAM infrastructure.

Respectfully submitted,

Carl E. Jones III

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